

Chapter

What the Body's Design Reveals — The Truth About Vegetarian and Non-Vegetarian Food



Introduction: A Question of Food, an Answer from the Body

What we should eat is usually decided by taste, habit or tradition. In this short discourse, however, Acharya Upendra Ji offers a different perspective: the answer, he says, is written in the design of our own body. How the human digestive system is built, and how it differs from that of meat-

eating animals, is what he explains through a simple household example.

The Long Human Digestive System

Acharya Ji first asks us to look at our own body medically:

"If you look at it a little medically — if you open up your small intestine and look at everything, at the whole process of digestion going on inside you, at its structure, your entire digestive system — then you have a very long digestive system."

Meat-eating animals, by contrast, are built quite differently:

"In those who eat non-veg, it is extremely short, very small. Research will tell you this too; medical science also knows it."

He also makes clear the reason for this difference:

"Why would it be like that? So that it leaves their body immediately. There is a lot of waste in all this."

Nature made the digestive tract of meat-eating animals short, so that the waste of meat leaves the body quickly.

What Is Already Dead Rots Within

What is the basic difference between veg and non-veg? Acharya Ji explains that meat stays in the body much longer:

"There is a difference between veg and non-veg. Non-veg will be kept in the stomach for a longer time. If it stays in here a long time — our intestine has this kind of structure — then fermentation will happen right inside."

And he states plainly why this rotting happens:

"If it stays inside that long, fermentation will happen, because it is already a dead thing. Decomposition has already started. So if it remains inside the body for that long, fermentation, decomposition, all of it will happen, and disease will come."

Meat is dead matter whose decomposition has already begun; in the long human digestive tract it stays for a long time and rots — and that is where disease is born.

Layers That Build Up Over Years

The effect is not limited to that one day. Acharya Ji explains that the waste of what we eat can stay inside for years:

"That is why, in a human being, even what was eaten ten years ago — all such things keep collecting, collecting, collecting in the intestine. Some of it starts fermenting right there. Not everything comes out of it."

"Gradually those layers keep growing and growing, and they keep making its passage smaller and smaller."

What does not fully leave the body builds up layer by layer and slowly narrows the passage of the intestines itself.

The Wash Basin Pipe: A Simple Example

Acharya Ji explains the whole point with an example found in every home:

"Your basin — the wash basin — have you seen the pipe under it? It is usually white, it is corrugated, it has ring-like ridges in it."

"And there is another pipe that is completely clean — a normal garden pipe for watering. In the one that is completely clean, oil, ghee and so on can all flow out immediately, can't they? Grease — if the pipe is corrugated, what will happen? It will get stuck."

So there are two kinds of pipe:

- **Smooth pipe** — smooth on the inside; oil and grease flow straight through without stopping.
- **Corrugated pipe** — ridged on the inside; the same grease gets stuck in its folds.

The Human Design: Made to Absorb Rasa and Sattva

Now Acharya Ji applies the example to the body:

"So vegetarians are different, and they are different. For whom would it be smooth? If it has to pass out immediately, it will be smooth."

The human body is built for another purpose:

"The human being is not like that. Ours is for absorption — we have to take in a lot of **sattva**, a lot of **rasa**. So our structure is different."

Here **sattva** means the essence of the food, and **rasa** the nourishing fluid formed from food, which Ayurveda counts as the first tissue (**dhatu**) of the body. The human intestines are made to draw out this essence slowly from food.

"Their structure is smooth, so that nothing gets stuck much; it goes straight out."

The human digestive system is like a corrugated pipe — made to extract the most **rasa** and **sattva** from food; that of meat-eating animals is like a smooth pipe — made to throw out what remains at once.

Why Does the Lion Not Fall Ill, but the Human Does?

From this comes the conclusion at the heart of the discourse:

"Let a lion eat deer any time, as much as it likes — it will not get ill. You will."

And at the end, Acharya Ji draws the whole example together once more:

"What is our pipeline like? It is a corrugated pipe. Everything has been arranged to extract a lot. Theirs is for passing out immediately. As much as is needed stays; everything else of theirs is thrown out."

Food that is natural for the lion becomes a cause of disease for the human being — because the two bodies are built

for different purposes.

Summary: Key Takeaways

- 1 The body's design is the answer** — the human digestive system is long, while that of meat-eating animals is very short; medical science agrees.
- 2 Meat is already dead matter** — its decomposition has already begun, and in the long human tract it stays a long time, causing fermentation and disease.
- 3 Waste collects for years** — what does not fully leave builds up layer by layer and narrows the intestinal passage.
- 4 Smooth and corrugated pipes** — the intestines of meat-eating animals are like a smooth pipe, where everything flows straight out; the human ones are like a corrugated pipe, where grease gets stuck.
- 5 The human being is made for *rasa* and *sattva*** — our design is for absorbing the essence of food, not for throwing waste out at once.

6 **No disease for the lion, disease for the human** — what is natural for one creature can be harmful to another; choosing food according to the nature of one's own body is true discernment.